

Sumaiya Akhter Ahona

Research Interest

Development Economics, Labor and Gender Economics, International Trade, and Applied Microeconomics, with interests in policy evaluation and inclusive economic development.

Education

- 2025–Present **Master of Science in Economics with Data Analytics**
Woody Hunt School of Business, The University of Texas at El Paso, USA.
Concentration: Economics with Data Analytics
- 2021–2024 **Master of Business Administration (MBA)**
BRAC Business School, BRAC University, Bangladesh.
Concentration: Marketing
- 2016–2020 **Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA)**
BRAC Business School, BRAC University, Bangladesh.
Concentration: Marketing
Minor- Human Resource Management

Experience

- Sep, 2025 - Present **Graduate Teaching Assistant**, *Department of Economics and Finance*, The University of Texas at El Paso, El Paso, TX
Courses Assisted:

Undergraduate: Business Analytics – R Programming; Business Statistics & Analytics I – Excel; Business Statistics & Analytics II – Excel; Principles of Macroeconomics.

Graduate: Microeconomic Theory; Economics & Finance Applications of Python Programming.

- Support undergraduate and graduate-level instruction in economics, statistics, business analytics, and programming-based data analysis courses.
- Provide academic support to students on economic theory, statistical reasoning, data analysis, and problem-solving strategies.
- Grade homework, quizzes, projects, and exams using instructor-provided rubrics and provide constructive feedback.
- Assist faculty in preparing teaching materials, rubrics, answer keys, and course-related analytical exercises.
- Maintain grade records and coordinate with instructors on course progress and instructional needs.

- Sep, 2022 - July, 2024 **Relationship Specialist, International Business Department, Apex Footwear Limited**
- Conducted market research on international footwear trends, consumer preferences, and demand patterns across European and Japanese markets to support product, pricing, and business decisions.
 - Analyzed differences in client purchasing behavior, market demand, and consumer preferences across international markets, developing an interest in how economic conditions and market characteristics shape demand and firm decision-making.
 - Evaluated product-level cost breakdowns, pricing, and pre- versus post-production profitability to assess margins and support production and pricing decisions.
 - Examined market demand and account performance to support production-capacity allocation, sales planning, and business strategy across approximately 35 international brand accounts, including ALDO, Zalando, Wolverine, and Caterpillar.
 - Conducted root-cause analyses of quality and operational issues and developed corrective action plans based on production and account-level information.
 - Conducted quarterly analysis of Apex Footwear's contribution to Bangladesh's leather and footwear export sector, examining export values, market trends, and the company's relative position within the national industry.
- Nov, 2020 - Aug, 2022 **Senior Executive, Business Development (Tender and Procurement), Multimedia Content and Communications Limited (MCC Ltd.), Bangladesh**
- Conducted research on government ICT and infrastructure projects, examining project objectives, institutional requirements, procurement conditions, and public-sector development priorities.
 - Researched and synthesized information for Expression of Interest (EOI) and Request for Proposal (RFP) submissions to government ministries, public agencies, NGOs, and international organizations.
 - Maintained and analyzed a master database of government and institutional projects, tracking project information, procurement requirements, and implementation status to support evidence-based planning and decision-making.
 - Collaborated with the accounts team to analyze project budgets and cost components, contributing to financial planning and evaluation of proposed projects.
 - Conducted background research and prepared analytical briefs, presentations, and speech materials for government stakeholders, including work associated with Bangladesh's ICT Ministry.
- Aug, 2018 - Aug, 2019 **Client Service Executive, Wire Digital Multimedia Marketing Agency, Bangladesh**
- Handled 18 clients and created marketing plans for them.
 - Analyzed the existing client base and formulate effective planning to reach the potential client and effectively followed up.
 - Organized online and offline campaigns.
 - Developed marketing content for clients and companies.
 - Prepared billing and invoicing for services rendered.
 - Pitched ideas to clients and assisted in managing campaigns.
 - Coordinated with management team to ensure target is met as stated in the KPI.
 - Guided the creative team on client requirements and preferences.
 - Worked as part-time there.

Honors and Awards

- June 2025 **Recipient**, James Foundation Graduate Scholarship, awarded by the Office of Scholarships, The University of Texas at El Paso.

Technical and Quantitative Skills

Econometrics	Applied Econometrics; Regression Analysis; Policy Evaluation; Data Cleaning; Data Visualization.
Software	Stata; R Programming; Python; SQL; Microsoft Excel; LaTeX.
Presentation	Microsoft PowerPoint, Beamer.
Mathematics	Mathematical Economics; Linear Algebra (Appearing in Spring, 2027)

Research Experience

- Apr, 2026 - **Student Dropout and Academic Success Prediction**, *Applied Research Project* —
May, 2026 *Python* — *UTEP* — *Spring 2026*
- Analyzed data on 4,424 higher-education students to examine predictors of dropout, enrollment, and graduation.
 - Applied Logistic Regression, Decision Tree, and Random Forest models in Python using cross-validation and out-of-sample evaluation.
 - Examined academic, financial, and economic predictors of student outcomes; Random Forest achieved 77.5% test accuracy.

Certifications and Technical Training

- IBM/Coursera Selected Data Science Coursework, offered through The University of Texas at El Paso.
- Courses
- Data Analysis with Python
 - Data Visualization with Python
 - Databases and SQL for Data Science with Python
 - Python Project for Data Science
 - Machine Learning with Python
 - Tools for Data Science

Selected Leadership and Extra-Curricular Services

- Aug, 2016 - **Co-Director, Media and Communication Department**, *BIZ BEE, BRAC University*
Dec, 2019 *Business Club*, BRAC University, Bangladesh
- Led media relations, event communication, and external outreach for university-level business programs, workshops, and competitions.
 - Coordinated with student teams, media partners, and external sponsors to support event planning, promotion, and stakeholder communication.
- Nov, 2018 - **Senior Executive, Marketing and Sponsorship Department**, *BRAC University*
Dec, 2019 *Adventure Club*, BRAC University, Bangladesh
- Supported sponsorship outreach, promotional campaigns, and partnership communication for student-led university events.
 - Helped develop sponsorship proposals and maintain relationships with external partners.
- Selected Event Leadership Served in team lead, supervisor, and event coordination roles for the Bangladesh Leather Footwear and Leather-goods International Sourcing Show, Apex Gala Night, E-Carnival, Brainiacs, and ADWIZ.

Reference

Jose Bucheli

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